BSU-IACUC User Manual

For reviewers: reviewing protocols and giving feedback

About this manual

Reviewers read submitted protocols, mark up the document with comments, and either return the protocol for revision or finish the review. You can replay the interactive User Guide from the footer or the account menu, and the Page guide button on the Protocol Inbox.

1. Set up your account

1. Ask an administrator for a personnel registration link for the reviewer role. Links expire after 48 hours.
2. Open the link and complete the registration form. You receive an email that your application was received.
3. Wait for administrative staff to approve your account. Your account stays pending until then.
4. Sign in through the personnel sign-in page.

2. The Protocol Inbox

Dashboard opens the Protocol Inbox, which lists the protocols for you to review.

- **Search** by protocol title or the researcher's name.
- **Status filters** narrow the inbox. It opens on **To review**, which is your queue. The number next to each name is how many protocols have that status.
- **Sort** by newest or oldest submitted, or by title.
- **Status colors**: press the question mark at the end of the status bar to see what each status means for you.
- **Protocol card**: shows the status icon, research title, submission round, and researcher. Press the researcher's name to see their details.
- **Pagination** at the bottom lets you move between pages and choose how many rows to show.

3. Review a protocol

1. Press **Review** on a protocol in To review. Protocols in other statuses show **View** instead, and **View Clearance** once approved.
2. Read the protocol in the viewer.
3. Draw an annotation box on the part of the document you want to comment on, and type your comment.
4. Edit or delete your comments as needed. Comments are what the researcher sees when the protocol is returned.

4. Make a decision

Decision	How it works
Return for revision	Use this when the researcher must fix something. Add any notes for the researcher. The protocol moves to Needs Revision and the researcher is notified. Only protocols under review can be returned.
Finish the review	Mark the protocol as Reviewed when your assessment is complete. Protocol details are then added to the records automatically.

A protocol cannot be marked Reviewed while it still has comments. Either return it for revision so the researcher can address them, or remove the comments to confirm that nothing is outstanding.

After the researcher resubmits, the protocol returns to Under Review. **Show History** lists every submission round, including the researcher's revisions.

5. What happens after review

Once you mark a protocol as Reviewed, administrative staff take over: payment verification, IPN, endorsement, and approval. You can follow the protocol's progress from the Dashboard and the Records page.

6. Records and statistics

- **Records** lists every protocol record. Search, filter by school, animal type, sex, researcher type, or status, and sort the list. Open a record's protocol file with the eye icon.
- **Statistics** shows review activity, record totals, and breakdowns for a period you choose, and **Download as Excel** exports them.

7. Other tools

- **Preview public site** in the header shows the site the way visitors see it.
- **Notifications**: the bell shows a badge when there is something new.
- Staff and reviewers can delete a protocol directly with the **Delete** button. Use it with care.

For anything else, use the Contact Us page or ask administrative staff.